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THE METROPOLITAN

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Weekend Review 12 Pages

From mass-timber concert halls to underground micro-parks, urbanists are prioritizing acoustic sanity over visual spectacle.

Architecture of Silence: Why the New Metropolises Are Rediscovering Acoustical Commons

ESSAY BY MARA LIN, ARCHITECTURE & DESIGN CRITIC

ROTTERDAM —

Urban life has long traded sonic peace for economic vitality. Yet across Rotterdam, Kyoto, and Montreal, a counter-revolution in municipal design is transforming civic architecture.

Engineers are replacing concrete echo-chambers with perforated cork baffles, natural water curtains, and subterranean cloister gardens designed specifically to absorb low-frequency automotive rumble.

A new retrospective celebrates the tactile mastery of independent private press printers.

Critical Review: The Ephemeral Poetics of Modernist Bookmaking

REVIEW BY SIMONE DUBOIS

In an age dominated by disposable liquid-crystal pixels, the enduring weight of rag paper and letterpress impression offers an almost defiant sensory clarity.

The traveling exhibition highlights eighty remarkable volumes printed on hand-fed cylinder presses over the past three decades.

Ancient micro-organisms are transforming industrial biotechnology and haute cuisine alike.

The Fermentation Renaissance

BY HENRIK LINDQVIST

COPENHAGEN —

In a modest converted brewery outside Copenhagen, microbiologists are cultivating wild yeasts capable of synthesizing complex flavor compounds from discarded agricultural biomass.

The venture reflects a growing shift among leading culinary labs toward closed-loop biological production.